

Mayer Brown × SEO Masterclass · cheat sheet

Mon 2 Nov 2026 · 2-6pm · London · Business smart · keep travel receipts (≤£150)

The protocol (45-75 seconds)

1 Steady breathe, restate in one line · **2 Sort** name the tension, rank it · **3 Act** who, what, by when · **4 Close** one principle, stop.

Priority order

1 Rules and the firm's name → 2 the client, served fairly → 3 the process and the record → 4 speed.
"Rules and the client first, keep the record straight, then as fast as that allows."

Never

Say "Brown & Wood" · call Van Gorp managing partner · say Mayer Brown leads London securitisation or pensions (tier 2) · say it pays US rates · claim "biggest in Hong Kong" · mention pay as a motive · repeat anything said off the record · call the Aug 2026 incident a hack · badmouth a rival.

Counters to frame-breaking

Interrupted: "Sure," answer, then finish in one line · Contradicted: "Which part?" update on facts only · Silence: don't fill it · Escalation: same order, faster · Authority: "I'd do it, and raise it with them first" · False choice: "I don't think they conflict here..." · Don't know: "Not yet; from first principles..." · Badmouth: praise rival precisely, state your fit.

Ask one of these

"Derivatives reached the Legal 500 top tier this year: how much is transatlantic, and where do trainees fit?" · "Basel 3.1 starts 1 Jan: are you seeing more risk transfer work?" · "How do the new leveraged finance teams fit with the bank-side practices?"

Why Mayer Brown (30 seconds)

Work: London top tier in derivatives, asset-based lending, trade finance. Shape: ~15 trainees, real work. Moment: London +20.5% by going "deeper with fewer clients"; Basel 3.1 drives risk transfer, where the firm is SRT Law Firm of the Year.

Numbers if asked

Global revenue 2025	\$2.17bn (+~10%)
Profit per equity partner	\$3.196m (+14.5%)
London revenue 2025	\$268.2m (+20.5%, record)
London lawyers	~264; LLP turnover £185.7m (FY Apr 2025)
Clients billed	6,316 (from 7,600)
Trainees / pay	~15 a year; £56k / £61k; NQ £150k; 80% kept
Legal 500 UK 2027	47 areas; 5 top tier
Vac scheme deadline	4 Dec 2026 ; TC 31 Mar 2027
Bank Rate	3.75% (6-3 hold, 17 Sep); next 5 Nov
Basel 3.1	1 Jan 2027
SQE1 pass rate	42% (July 2026)

People

Chair **Jon Van Gorp** · MP **Jeremy Clay** · London MP **Chris Harvey** (real estate, from 1 Oct 2026) · ex-London MP **Dominic Griffiths** (structured finance, now Mgmt Committee) · Training Principal **Miriam Bruce** (trainee 2005, partner 2020) · B&F co-head **Alex Dell** · Derivatives **Ed Parker**

History in one line

Chicago 1881 (Kraus & Mayer) · London Rowe & Maw 1895 · combined 2002 · "Mayer Brown" 2007 · JSM Hong Kong 2008-2024.

Three stories to know

Ford £4.6bn buy-in (Oct 2025): insurance + pensions partners together · Securitisation reform consultation (17 Feb 2026) · Lev fin team from Baker McKenzie (1 Sep 2026).

Sources for every figure: Parts 2, 4, 7 and the source table. Calm: breathe out longer than in; pause before answering, not during.